Where Do Credit Card Customers Struggle?

A one-year view of complaint volume and resolution outcomes across five major banks

QUESTION

Which complaint areas matter most — and which banks provide more relief?

42,838
credit card complaints

5
banks compared

12 months
27 Oct 2025 – 27 Oct 2026

METHOD

Clean → analyse → visualise

- Cleaned complaint records and derived relief / response metrics.
- Used SQL and Python (pandas) for analysis.
- Built dashboards in Looker Studio and Power BI.

KEY METRIC

Relief rate

Share of complaints closed with monetary or non-monetary relief.

This metric focuses on outcome, not simply response speed.

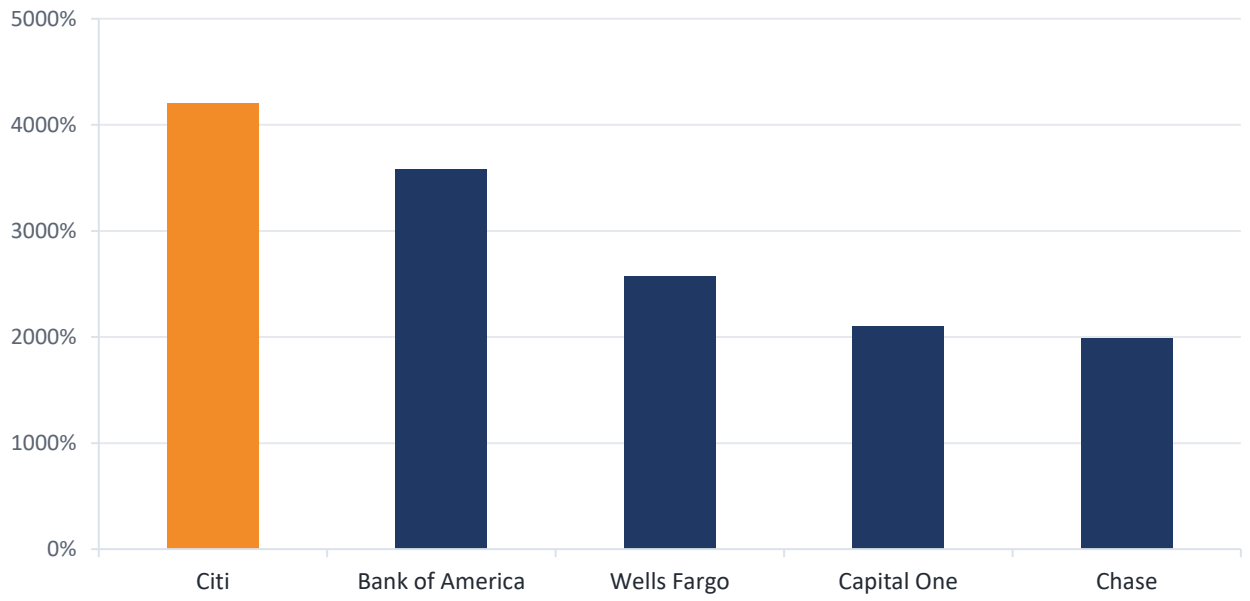
Source: CFPB Consumer Complaint Database | Analysis by author

Outcomes, not speed, separate the banks

Relief rates vary substantially even though timely-response rates are close to 100%

RELIEF RATE BY BANK

Citi leads the five-bank comparison



KEY FINDINGS

36.6% of complaints are purchase disputes — the leading issue across the five banks.

~100% timely response rate is broadly consistent across the banks.

22.1 pp gap separates Citi (42.0%) from Chase (19.9%) on relief rate.

Outcome relief rate shows a clearer separation between banks than response speed.

Source: CFPB Consumer Complaint Database | Analysis by author

What Should Banks Improve First?

Four practical actions suggested by the complaint patterns

PRIORITY **Focus first on high-volume disputes and the customer journey around resolution.**

01

Resolve disputes

Simplify dispute and chargeback processes, with clearer status updates for customers.

02

Support customers

Make hardship assistance and payment-support options easier to find and understand.

03

Improve categories

Break broad complaint categories into specific issues to identify recurring problems.

04

Clarify fees & interest

Make fee, interest-rate and payment terms easier to understand before customers commit.

These are analytical recommendations based on observed complaint patterns, not causal claims.

Source: CFPB Consumer Complaint Database | Recommendations based on observed complaint patterns